

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF BRONX

-----X
TAQUAN HUNTER,

Index No.

Purchased 9-6-22

Plaintiff

Plaintiff designates Bronx
County as the place of trial

- against -

The basis of the venue is
where the tort arose

THE CITY OF NEW YORK,
POLICE OFFICER JONATHAN KEITH (shield # 19375)
and POLICE OFFICER JOHN DOE,

SUMMONS

Defendants.

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TO THE ABOVE-NAMED DEFENDANTS:

YOU ARE HEREBY SUMMONED to answer the complaint in this action and to serve a copy of your answer, or if the complaint is not served with this summons, to serve a notice of appearance on the Plaintiff's attorney(s) within 20 days after the service of this summons, exclusive of the day of service (or within 30 days after the service is complete if this summons is not personally delivered to you within the State of New York); and in case of your failure to appear or answer, judgment will be taken against you by default for the relief demanded in the complaint.

Dated: Bronx, NY
September 6, 2022



THE LAW OFFICES OF ELLIOT S. KAY
Attorney for Plaintiff
888 Grand Concourse, Suite 1H
Bronx, NY 10451
(212) 939-7251

Defendant's Address:
CORPORATION COUNSEL OF THE
CITY OF NEW YORK
100 Church Street
New York, New York 10007

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
BRONX COUNTY

-----X
TAQUAN HUNTER,

Plaintiff,

Index No.

Verified Complaint

- against -

THE CITY OF NEW YORK,
POLICE OFFICER JONATHAN KEITH (shield # 19375)
and POLICE OFFICER JOHN DOE,

Defendants.
-----X

Plaintiff TAQUAN HUNTER, by his attorneys THE LAW OFFICES OF ELLIOT S. KAY, by ELLIOT S. KAY, principal, complaining of the Defendants, respectfully shows to this Court and alleges the following upon information and belief:

PARTIES

1. At all times hereinafter mentioned, Plaintiff TAQUAN HUNTER was a resident of the State of New York.
2. At all times hereinafter mentioned, Defendant THE CITY OF NEW YORK ("CITY") was and still is a municipal corporation organized and existing under and by virtue of the laws of the State of New York.
3. At all times hereinafter mentioned, THE NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT ("POLICE") was and is an agency of Defendant CITY.
4. At all times hereinafter mentioned, Defendants POLICE OFFICER JONATHAN KEITH (shield # 19375) and POLICE OFFICER JOHN DOE were and are police officers employed by Defendants.

BACKGROUND

5. On June 8, 2021, at approximately 3:30 p.m., in the vicinity of East Tremont Avenue and Grand Concourse in Bronx County, without just cause or provocation, Defendants, including POLICE OFFICER JONATHAN KEITH (shield # 19375) and POLICE OFFICER JOHN DOE, approached Plaintiff, tackled Plaintiff, struck Plaintiff and violently handcuffed Plaintiff. The Defendants intentionally and falsely accused Plaintiff of having committed the crime of Reckless Endangerment in the Second Degree and related charges.

6. Next, Plaintiff was taken to a police precinct in Bronx County.

7. Plaintiff was forced to remain in a precinct holding cell until Plaintiff was released from custody with a Desk Appearance Ticket on June 9, 2021.

8. When Plaintiff appeared in Court on August 13, 2021, Plaintiff received an Adjournment in Contemplation of Dismissal with immediate sealing and the matter was dismissed and sealed.

PROCEDURAL POSTURE

9. On February 7, 2022, Plaintiff served a Notice of Claim in writing sworn to on Plaintiff's behalf upon Defendant CITY, by delivering a copy thereof to the officer designated to receive such process personally, which Notice of Claim advised the Defendant of the nature, place, time, and manner in which the claim arose, and the items of damage and injuries sustained so far as was then determinable. The Court granted Plaintiff's application to file a late Notice of Claim nunc pro tunc on May 17, 2022.

10. More than thirty days have elapsed since service of said notice, and defendant CITY has failed to pay or adjust this claim.

11. This action has been commenced within one year and ninety days after the cause of action accrued.

12. Plaintiff has duly complied with all conditions precedent to the commencement of this action.

FIRST CAUSE OF ACTION: FALSE IMPRISONMENT

13. Paragraphs 1-12 are incorporated by reference as fully set forth herein.

14. Plaintiff was aware of Plaintiff's arrest and confinement as described in paragraphs 5-8, and Plaintiff did not consent to that arrest or confinement.

15. Defendants intended to confine Plaintiff and the confinement was not privileged or authorized by any warrant, order, or other legal right. Defendant's lacked probable cause to arrest Plaintiff.

16. As a result of being falsely imprisoned by the Defendants, Plaintiff sustained multiple injuries, including loss of liberty, emotional distress, humiliation and fear and intimidation for Plaintiff's safety.

SECOND CAUSE OF ACTION: ASSAULT

17. Paragraphs 1-16 are incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.

18. POLICE OFFICER JONATHAN KEITH (shield # 19375), acting as the agent, servant and employee of the Defendants, placed Plaintiff in apprehension of imminent harmful or offensive contact by approaching, tackling, striking and violently handcuffing Plaintiff.

19. As a result of being assaulted by POLICE OFFICER JONATHAN KEITH (shield # 19375), Plaintiff sustained multiple injuries, including substantial pain to his body, emotional distress, humiliation, loss of enjoyment of life and fear and intimidation for his safety.

THIRD CAUSE OF ACTION: BATTERY

20. Paragraphs 1-19 are incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.

21. When POLICE OFFICER JONATHAN KEITH (shield # 19375) approached, tackled, struck and violently handcuffed Plaintiff, he subjected Plaintiff to a harmful or offensive bodily contact. POLICE OFFICER JONATHAN KEITH (shield # 19375) intended to make that contact without Plaintiff's consent.

22. As a result of being battered by POLICE OFFICER JONATHAN KEITH (shield # 19375), Plaintiff sustained multiple injuries, including substantial pain to his body, loss of liberty, emotional distress, humiliation, loss of enjoyment of life and fear and intimidation for his safety.

WHEREFORE, Plaintiff demands judgment against the Defendants, together with the costs and disbursements of this action in the amount of damages greater than the jurisdictional limit of any lower court that would otherwise have jurisdiction, together with attorneys' fees and costs for bringing this case, and punitive damages.

Dated: Bronx, NY
September 6, 2022

Yours, etc.,

THE LAW OFFICES OF ELLIOT S. KAY



BY: ELLIOT S. KAY, ESQ.
Attorney for Plaintiff
888 Grand Concourse, Suite 1H
Bronx, NY 10451
212-939-7251

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF BRONX

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TAQUAN HUNTER,

Plaintiff,

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THE CITY OF NEW YORK,
POLICE OFFICER JONATHAN KEITH (shield # 19375)
and POLICE OFFICER JOHN DOE,

Defendants.

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VERIFICATION

I, **ELLIOT S. KAY**, an attorney admitted to practice in the courts of New York State, state that I am the attorney of record for Plaintiff in the within action; I have read the foregoing and know the contents thereof; the same is true to my own knowledge, except as to the matters therein stated to be alleged on information and belief, and as to those matters I believe it to be true. The reason this verification is made by me and not the Plaintiff is because Plaintiff currently resides outside the county where deponent maintains his office.

I affirm that the foregoing statements are true, under the penalties of perjury.

Dated: Bronx, NY
September 6, 2022



ELLIOT S. KAY